# RaveStack Risk and Cohort Churn Analysis Insight Report

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# EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

RaveStack VDesk, a virtual office platform, currently has an unsustainable churn rate of 70.4%, resulting in an estimated $1.3 billion in lost annual recurring revenue (ARR). Accounts are discontinuing subscriptions at multiple stages of the lifecycle rendering the sales pipeline unstable. Stakeholders commissioned this analysis to identify key churn drivers and pinpoint where interventions would have the greatest impact.

The analysis results show that churn drivers change significantly based on account age, indicating that applying a one-size-fits-all retention strategy would be unsuccessful. Early-stage accounts (12 months or less) primarily churn due to pricing sensitivity. In contrast, older accounts (13-24+ months) primarily churn due to support dissatisfaction and feature gaps. The majority of accounts fell between low and moderate risk levels with rare high risk accounts that churned quickly. Cohort retention rates average at only 29.6% yet active subscriptions showed repeated recoveries, signaling steady demand and consistent new subscribers.

This analysis quantifies the financial impact of churn, identifying the specific friction points driving churn at each level and providing strategies tailored to each level's unique needs to reduce churn, stabilise recurring revenue and improve retention.

# BUSINESS CONTEXT AND PROBLEM

RaveStack VDesk, a virtual office platform currently has an unsustainable churn rate of 70.4%, resulting in an estimated $1.3 billion in lost annual recurring revenue (ARR). Accounts are discontinuing subscriptions at multiple stages of the lifecycle rendering the sales pipeline unstable. Stakeholders commissioned this analysis to identify key churn drivers and pinpoint where interventions would have the greatest impact.

This analysis should identify the specific friction points driving churn at each level and provide strategies tailored to each level's unique needs to reduce churn, stabilise recurring revenue and improve retention.

# OBJECTIVES AND SUCCESS CRITERIA

## Objectives:

Identify primary churn drivers across risk levels, cohort groups, pricing tiers and account ages.
Quantify the financial impact of churn on ARR and MRR
Assess support operations as a churn driver
Provide actionable recommedations tailored to each segment to improve retention

## Success Criteria:

Distinct churn trends identified in early stage versus late stage accounts
Churned ARR and MRR quantified and broken down by risk levels, tier plans and cohorts
Support metrics (resolution time, ticket volume, high-priority ticket frequency) linked to churn factors

# ROLE, DATA AND METHODOLOGY

This is an end-to-end analysis, covering data ingestion, transformation, dimensional modeling, exploratory analysis, data visualisation and insight development for stakeholders.

## Data and Tools:

**Data**: Billing subscription data, support desk ticket data, CRM account data, product analytics feature usage data and sales churn event data.
**Tools**: SQL Server - database creation, data cleaning, transformation and dimensional modeling.
Power BI - modeling and visualisation.

**Analytical Techniques:**

**Data pipeline development** - Designed and implemented a structured ETL process with data moving from staging tables to normalised raw tables and then clean business-ready tables with standardised attributes.

**Dimensional modeling** - Built star schema models with fact and dimension tables to enable flexible analysis across accounts, subscriptions and support operations.

**Customer 360 view creation** - Developed account and subscription level views collecting behavioural, financial and support data into single comprehensive sources of truth.

**Risk scoring** - Created a weighted risk model including signals from feature usage and support ticket patterns to classify accounts into risk tiers.

**Cohort analysis** - Grouped accounts by their signup month to identify details like retention patterns and churn timing.

**Churn driver analysis** - Segmented churned accounts across multiple levels including account age to identify key churn drivers and friction points.

**Approach:**
Rather than extensive reporting, this analysis prioritised clear diagnostic answers and supporting stakeholder decision making. It focused on identifying patterns, isolating outliers and present contrasts to support stakeholders and precise retention strategies tailored to each segment's unique needs. These findings were then validated across multiple levels, account age, tier plan, risk level etc, to ensure insights and recommendations made were proven by consistent, multi-source evidence.

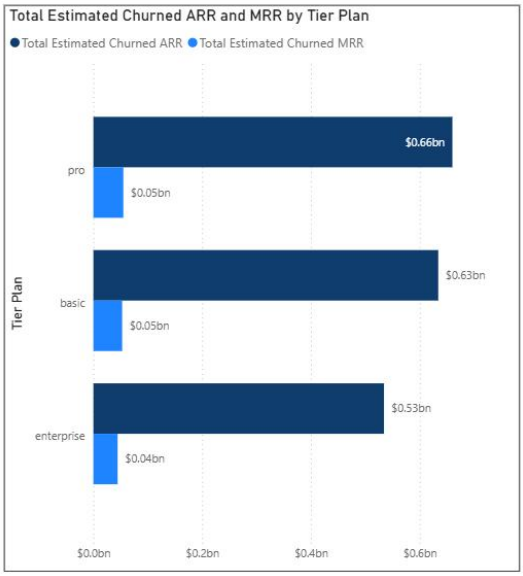
# KEY INSIGHTS AND ANALYSIS

## CHURN HAS RESULTED IN $1.3 BILLION IN LOST ANNUAL RECURRING REVENUE

| Total Churned Accounts | Total Churned Subscriptions | Churn Rate | Total Estimated Churned ARR | Total Estimated Churned MRR |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 352 | 6729 | 70.40% | $1.83bn | $152.35M |

Figure C1.1 Total Churned Accounts, Total Churned Subscriptions, Account Churn Rate, Total Estimated Churned ARR, Total Estimated Churned MRR

VDesk currently has 352 churned accounts, 6729 churned subscriptions and a high churn rate of 70.4%. This has led to an estimated loss of $1.3 billion in churned ARR and a monthly loss of $152.3 million.



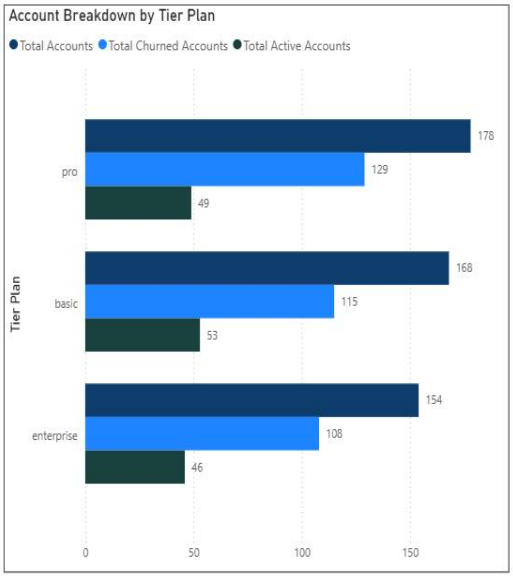




Figure C.2 Total Estimated Churned ARR and MRR by Tier Plan
Figure C.3 Account Breakdown by Tier Plan

The VDesk Pro tier has the largest number of accounts, 178 in total with 129 churned. It also has the largest ARR loss with a $660 million loss and a monthly MRR loss of $50 million. The Basic tier is a close second with 168 total accounts, 115 of which are churned, and an ARR loss of $630 million and a monthly MRR loss of $50 million. The Enterprise tier has 154 accounts in total, 108 of which are churned and an ARR loss of $530 million and a month MRR loss of 40 million.

The Pro tier had the highest churn rate of all tiers, 72.4%, and the highest ARR loss, indicating that retention initiatives within the tier could assist in stabilising recurring revenue. The Basic tier had the lowest churn rate of all tiers, 68.4%, yet delivered the second highest ARR loss. An audit of Basic tier accounts could provide more insight into the revenue drivers within existing or churned accounts.

# PRICING SENSITIVITY DRIVES EARLY CHURN WHILE SUPPORT AND FEATURE DISSATISFACTION DRIVE LATE CHURN

To enable churn stage analysis, churned accounts were grouped under five categories. Early (6 months or less) accounts were accounts that churned within 6 months or less after sign up. First Year (12 months or less) accounts were accounts that churned after 6 months but less than a year after sign up. Mid Churn (13-18 months) accounts were accounts that churned after a year but less than 18 months after sign up. Second Year (19-24 months) accounts were accounts that churned after 18 months but less than 2 years after sign up. Late Churn (2+ years) accounts that churned after more than 2 years after sign up.

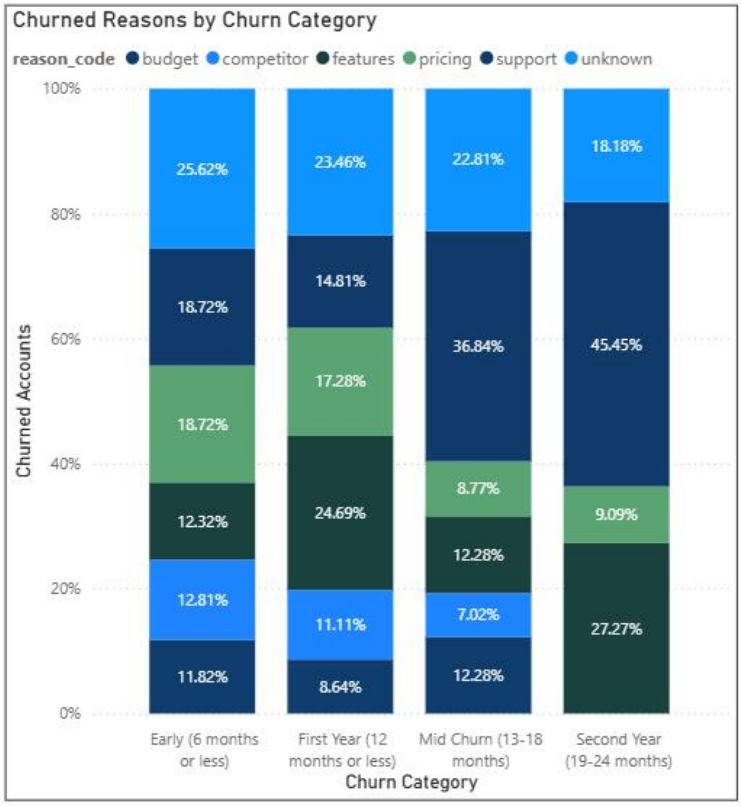



Figure C.3 Churn Reason by Churn Category

Price sensitivity played a key churn factor in Early (6 months or less) accounts accounting for 30.5% of all churn. Support dissatisfaction was a second key churn factor accounting for 18.7% of churn while competitor driven churn accounted for 12.8% of churn and feature dissatisfaction was 12.3%. For First Year (12 months or less) accounts, pricing sensitivity continued to drive churn, accounting for 25.8% of churn. Feature dissatisfaction became another key factor accounting for 24.6% of churn. Support dissatisfaction is a lesser churn factor being 14.81% of all churns and competitor driven churn was the smallest churn factor at 11.1%.

Within older accounts, support dissatisfaction becomes the lead churn factor accounting for 36.8% of Mid Churn (13-18 months) accounts total churn. Pricing sensitivity remained a key churn factor accounting for 21% of all churn followed by feature dissatisfaction at 12.2% and competitor driven churn at 7%. Support dissatisfaction continues to drive churn in Second Year (19-24 months) accounts, growing to 45.4% of all churn with feature dissatisfaction following at 27.2% while price dissatisfaction fell to 9%.

The variation in churn trends between accounts that churned early and the accounts that churned later indicates that two distinct streams of retention strategies and initiatives would be required to reduce churn rather than a one-size-fits-all strategy. Early churn accounts, i.e. Early (6 months or less) accounts and First Year (12 months or less) accounts, could benefit from price and value interventions to address price sensitivity and drive customer perceived value. Late churn accounts, i.e. Mid Churn (13-18 months) accounts and Second Year (19-24 months) accounts, could benefit from support and feature interventions to address support dissatisfaction and feature gaps. Price and value interventions could also work well with these accounts as price sensitivity remained a churn factor through both groups.

# HIGH-PRIORITY TICKETS PERSIST ACROSS CHURN CATEGORIES DESPITE FASTER RESOLUTION TIMES

To understand why support dissatisfaction drove churn, support ticket data was audited to identify the root causes. High-Priority Tickets are tickets which were marked as 'urgent' and 'high-priority' upon submission.

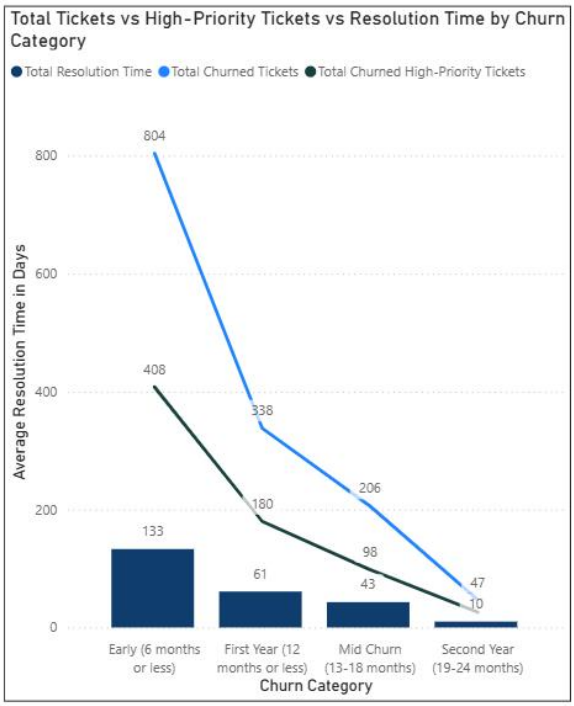



Figure C.3 Total Support Tickets vs High-Priority Tickets and Resolution Time by Churn Category

Support ticket metrics show contrasting patterns across churn categories. Early (6 months or less) accounts had the longest average resolution time of 133 days, with 408 high-priority tickets accounting for 50.7% of their 804 total tickets. First Year (12 months or less) accounts averaged 61 days of resolution time with 180 high-priority tickets, 53.2% of the 338 total tickets. Mid Churn (13-18 months) accounts averaged 43 days of resolution time with 98 high-priority tickets, 47.5% of 206 total tickets. Second Year (19-24 months) accounts averaged the fastest resolution time of 10 days yet high-priority tickets still accounted for 55.3% of 47 total tickets.

Later stage accounts had faster resolution time despite support dissatisfaction being the largest churn factor for both Mid Churn (13-18 months) and Second Year (19-24 months) accounts. While high-priority tickets accounted for majority of Second Year (19-24 months) accounts support needs, Mid Churn (13-18 months) accounts had the lowest proportion of high-priority tickets, 47.5%, yet still churned due to support dissatisfaction. In contrast early stage accounts, Early (6 months or less) and First Year (12 months or less), had high volumes of high-priority tickets and longer resolution times yet pricing sensitivity proved the largest churn driver for these groups.

These results indicate that resolution times and high-priority ticket numbers do not determine whether support issues lead to churn. A deeper audit of high-priority ticket content, particularly for late stage accounts, could identify common pain points and inform targeted retention strategies.

# LOW AND MODERATE RISK ACCOUNTS DOMINATE CHURN, NOT HIGH-RISK ACCOUNTS

To enable risk analysis, accounts were assigned risk scores and categories into risk levels. The overall risk score was calculated from a collection of factors; 50 points if an account did not use a feature within the first 30 days after signup, 30 points if it had a high amount of high-priority ticket submissions and 20 points if the account's overall ticket submissions were high. Accounts with over 80 points were classified as Elevated Risk accounts. Accounts with 50 to 79 points were classified as High-Risk accounts. Accounts with 20 to 49 points were classified as Moderate Risk accounts and accounts with no risk score were classified as Low Risk accounts.

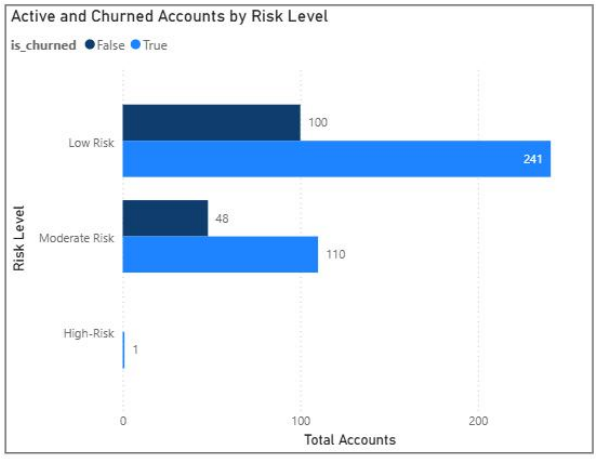



Figure R.1 Total Active and Churned Accounts by Risk Level

Low Risk accounts made up the largest risk group with 100 active accounts and 241 churned accounts. Moderate risk accounts followed with 48 active accounts and 110 churned accounts. Only one High-Risk account existed and no Elevated Risk accounts. This suggests that support data and feature usage data may not be effective risk signals. Additional signals could help improve risk identification early and prevent churn.

# LOW RISK ACCOUNTS GENERATE THE MAJORITY OF ARR ACROSS ALL LIFESPAN CATEGORIES

Account Lifespan Categories add a time-based dimension to the analysis. Accounts are grouped by active months; New Account (1 year or less), Emerging Account (1-3 years), Established Account (3-5 years) and Legacy Account (5+ years).

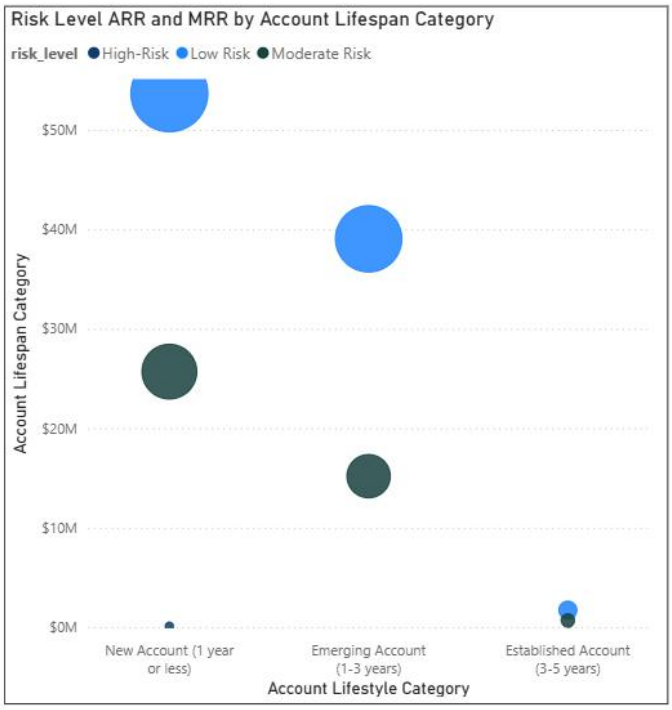



Figure R.2 Risk Level ARR and MRR by Account Lifespan Category

In the New Account (1 year or less) category, which was made up of only churned accounts, Low Risk accounts contributed the majority ARR share at $53.6 million, followed by Moderate Risk accounts at $25.6 million. The only High-Risk account in this group contributed $89 424. In the Emerging Account (1-3 years) category, Low Risk accounts accounted for 72% of total ARR, bringing in $39 million while Moderate Risk accounts contributed $15.1 million. Within this category, active accounts within account for $27.3 million of Low Risk ARR and $10.4 million of Moderate Risk ARR. In the Established Account (3-5 years) category, all accounts are active with Low Risk accounts bringing in $1.7 million in ARR and Moderate Risk accounts bringing in $668 904 in ARR.

This analysis has multiple implications. It indicates that despite being the largest contributor to ARR share, all new accounts have churned. Only one account was flagged as high risk with majority of the accounts churning flagged as low risk. It implies that the current risk criteria do not accurately represent churn risk and further investigation could identify effective churn risk flags.

# COHORT RETENTION IS LOW WITH STABLE DEMAND AND CONTINUOUS NEW SUBSCRIBERS

Accounts were assigned to cohorts based on their signup month. Cohort age(months since signup) was then used to group accounts into five categories; 0-3 Months, 3-6 Months, 6-12 Months, 12-24 Months, 24+ Months.

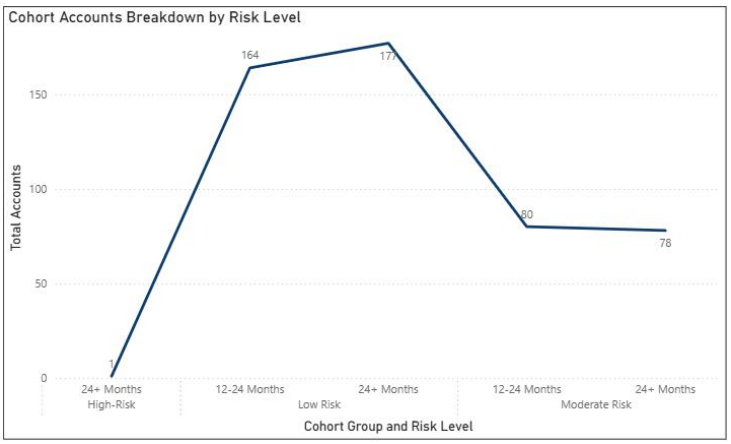



Figure CO.1 Cohort Group Account Breakdown by Risk Level

In the 12-24 Months cohort group, Low Risk accounts make up 67.21% of total accounts with 164 accounts and 80 Moderate Risk accounts. Of these accounts, 51 Low Risk accounts and 24 Moderate Risk accounts are active. In the 24+ Months cohort group Low Risk accounts make up 69.41% of total accounts with 177 accounts and 78 Moderate Risk accounts. Of these accounts, 49 Low Risk accounts and 24 Moderate Risk accounts are active.

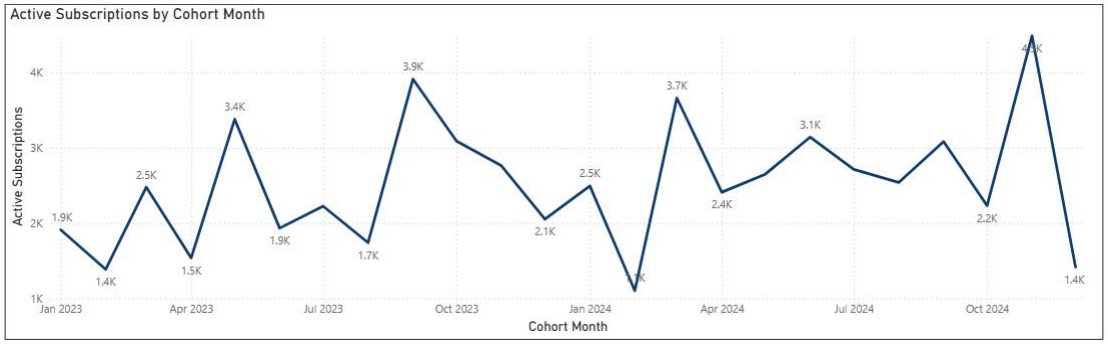



Figure CO.2 Active Subscriptions by Cohort Month

The average cohort account retention rate is currently 29.60%. Despite this low retention rate, active subscriptions have repeated recoveries suggesting steady demand and new subscriptions in spite of a high churn rate.

The analysis results clarifies that within the sales pipeline, customer acquisition is strong however the high churn rate is resulting in high cost per acquisition rates. Within older cohort groups, low risk accounts dominate. The results suggest however that the current risk criteria could be failing to catch churn risk effectively before churn.

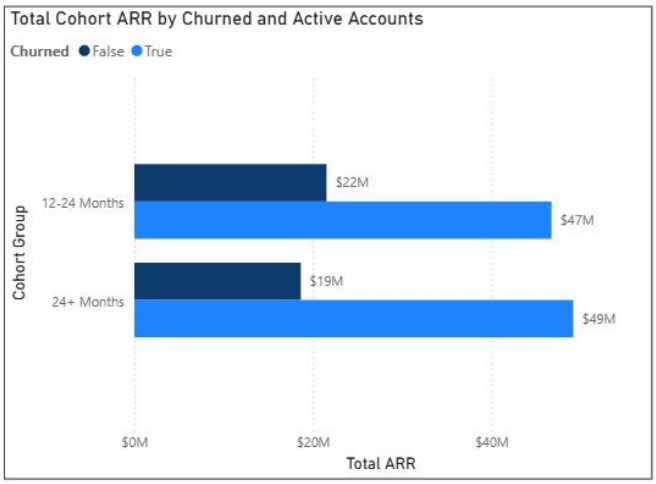



Figure CO.3 Total Cohort ARR by Churned and Active Accounts

Analyzing ARR at the cohort level shows that in the 12-24 Months cohort group, active accounts contributed $22 million while churned accounts contributed $47 million prior to churn. The 24+ Months cohort group, active accounts contributed $19 million, with churned accounts contributing $49 million prior to churn.

Together these cohorts contributed $96 million in ARR from churned accounts alone. This suggest that retention strategies targeting later stage cohort could recover and stabilise revenue with lower acquisition costs than sourcing new customers.

# STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

## SEPARATE RETENTION STRATEGIES BY ACCOUNT AGE

Accounts that churned early and accounts that churned later display variations in their churn trends signaling that two distinct streams of retention strategies and initiatives would be required to reduce churn rather than a one-size-fits-all strategy.

## PRIORITISE PRICE AND VALUE RETENTION STRATEGIES FOR EARLY CHURN ACCOUNTS

Price sensitivity is the leading churn reason in early churn accounts, i.e. Early (6 months or less) accounts and First Year (12 months or less) accounts. This means that interventions driving customer perceived value and addressing price sensitivity could be effective.

## PRIORITISE SUPPORT SATISFACTION AND FEATURE GAPS IN LATE CHURN ACCOUNT RETENTION STRATEGIES

Support dissatisfaction is the leading churn reason for late churn accounts, i.e. Mid Churn (13-18 months) accounts and Second Year (19-24 months) accounts, followed by feature gaps. Interventions addressing these could be effective alongside price and value interventions as price sensitivity remains a churn factor in late churn.

## AUDIT HIGH-PRIORITY TICKET SUPPORT DATA TO IDENTIFY PAIN POINTS

High-priority ticket numbers persisted through all churn categories despite resolution times reducing. The analysis indicated that these however do not determine whether support issues lead to churn. A deeper audit of high-priority ticket content, particularly for late stage accounts, could instead identify common pain points and inform targeted retention strategies.

## AUDIT CURRENT RISK SIGNALS AND EXPLORE OTHER EFFECTIVE SIGNALS TO TRACK CHURN RISK

Majority of the accounts churned churned while flagged as low risk. This It implies that the current risk criteria do not accurately represent churn risk, failing to catch churn risk effectively before churn. Further investigation could identify effective churn risk flags.

## TARGET LATER STAGE COHORTS WITH RETENTION STRATEGIES TO RECOVER REVENUE WITH LOWER ACQUISITION COSTS

The analysis results reveal that whilst customer acquisition is strong, the high churn rate results in high cost per acquisition rates. However, later stage cohorts contributed $96 million in ARR from churned accounts alone. This suggests that retention strategies targeting later stage cohorts could recover and stabilise revenue with lower acquisition costs than sourcing new customers.

# AUDIT BASIC TIER ACCOUNTS TO IDENTIFY REVENUE DRIVERS

Despite having the lowest churn rate of all tier plans, Basic tier accounts accounted for an ARR loss of $630 million. An audit of Basic tier accounts could identify revenue drivers within existing or churned accounts.

# ESTIMATED BUSINESS IMPACT

This analysis and its resulting recommended retention strategies aim to address the root causes of churn across the customer lifecycle, reduce recurring revenue loss, and improve retention rates. The following estimated impacts are based on the results from this analysis such as current churn rate and ARR figures. Predictions are made using industry benchmark target retention program ranges, 5-20%, and are conservative to reflect realistic and achievable results.

## RECOVERED REVENUE FROM LATER STAGE COHORTS

The 12–24 Month and 24+ Month cohort groups together represent $96 million in ARR from churned accounts alone. Targeting these groups could recover some of the churned ARR. Improving the retention rate by 10% within these cohorts would recover approximately $9.6 million in ARR. Even with a conservative prediction of 5% retention rate would recover $4.8 million in ARR.

## IMPROVED RETENTION AND REDUCED COST PER ACQUISITION

Increasing the retention rate by 10% would decrease the amount of new accounts needed to sustain revenue by approximately 25%. Repeated active subscription recoveries indicate strong customer acquisition so improving retention would shift sales into growth-oriented strategies.

## REDUCED SUPPORT-DRIVEN CHURN

Support dissatisfaction drives late stage churn and high priority tickets persist across all churn categories despite faster resolution times. An audit of high priority ticket content could help identify and resolve common pain points. This would address core support issues thus reducing support driven churn. A 20% reduction in support driven churn amongst late stage accounts would recover approximately $8.4 million in ARR annually.

## IMPROVED RISK SIGNAL EFFECTIVENESS

The analysis revealed that current risk signals did not effective signal churn risk as Low Risk accounts made up the largest churned group, 241 accounts. Refining risk signals could enable early churn risk identification. A reduction of churn by 5-10% across all segments could preserve from $65-130 million based on current churn levels.

## REVENUE RECOVERY FROM BASIC TIER ACCOUNTS

The Basic tier had the lowest churn rate of all tier plans, yet accounted for $630 million in ARR loss. A audit of Basic tier accounts could identify large or high revenue generating accounts driving ARR, enabling the development of a high value account retention strategy. Preserving just 5% of churned Basic tier ARR would recover $31.5 million in annual revenue.

# TECHNICAL APPENDIX

## DATA SOURCES

This analysis was conducted using transactional and operational data spanning account activity, subscription details, feature usage, support tickets, and churn events. The data set included account age, tier plan data, churn reason codes, support ticket volumes and resolution times, feature usage indicators and recurring revenue metrics.

**Data Tables Used:**
raw_accounts - Account-level attributes including signup date, plan tier, industry, and churn flag
raw_subscriptions - Subscription-level details including start/end dates, MRR, ARR, and billing frequency
raw_churn_events - Churn event records with reason codes, refund amounts, and feedback text
raw_feature_usage - Feature usage data including usage counts, duration, and error rates
raw_support_tickets - Support ticket records with submission dates, resolution times, priority levels, and satisfaction scores

## DATA MODEL OVERVIEW

The data model was built in SQL Server using a star schema approach to enable flexible analysis across accounts, subscriptions, and support operations. Revenue, churn, and support metrics were aggregated while maintaining clear analyses.

**Fact table:** clean_subscriptions - Core transaction fact containing subscription-level revenue and activity
**Dimension tables:** clean_accounts - Account attributes and demographics
clean_feature_usage - Feature adoption behavior
clean_support_tickets - Support interaction history
clean_churn_events - Churn event details
**Analytical views:** vw_customer_360_account - Consolidated account-level view with risk scoring, lifespan categorization, and cohort grouping
vw_customer_360_subscription – Subscription-level view for granular revenue analysis

## KEY MEASURES AND CALCULATIONS

**Key Measures:**
Churn Rate - Percentage of accounts that churned within the analysis period (churned accounts / total accounts)
Churned ARR - Total annual recurring revenue associated with churned subscriptions at time of churn
Churned MRR - Total monthly recurring revenue associated with churned subscriptions at time of churn

**Key Queries and Calculations:**
Resolution Time - Average days from ticket submission to closure, calculated using DATEDIFF(DAY, submitted_at, closed_at)
High-Priority Ticket - Tickets marked as "high" or "urgent" in the priority field

# RISK SCORING METHODOLOGY

Risk Score - Weighted composite score based on feature adoption and support ticket patterns

Risk scores were calculated at the account level using three weighted factors:
Feature non-usage (No feature usage within first 30 days of signup) - 50 points
High-priority ticket volume (3 or more high-priority tickets submitted) - 30 points
Total ticket volume (More than 10 total tickets submitted) - 20 points

Risk level assignment:
Elevated Risk - 80+ points
High Risk - 50-79 points
Moderate Risk - 20-49 points
Low Risk - 0-19 points

# ACCOUNT CATEGORISATION

**Churn Categories (by account age):**
Early - 0-6 months
First Year - 7-12 months
Mid Churn - 13-18 months
Second Year - 19-24 months
Late Churn - 2+ years

**Lifespan Categories:**
New Account - 12 months or less
Emerging Account - 13–36 months
Established Account - 37–60 months
Legacy Account - 60+ months

**Cohort Groups:**
0-3 Months - 3 months or less
3-6 Months - 3-6 months
6-12 Months - 6-12 months
12-24 Months - 12-24 months
24+ Months - 24+ months

# ANALYTICAL APPROACH

The analysis followed a structured diagnostic approach. Raw data was ingested and cleaned. Staging tables were imported and validated for nulls and data quality issues before loading into normalized raw tables. String standardization (LTRIM, RTRIM, LOWER) and data type conversions (TRY_CONVERT, TRY_CAST) were applied to ensure consistency. Clean tables were then created with standardized attributes, establishing a star schema foundation for analytical views. Account-level and subscription-level views were built to consolidate behavioral, financial, and support data into single sources of truth. Risk scoring, lifespan categorization, and cohort logic were embedded directly into these views.

Accounts were also categorised within various contexts to enable deeper analysis. Churned accounts were segmented by account age to identify key churn drivers and support ticket data was also analysed alongside churn events to determine links between support issues and churn. Accounts were also scored and classified into risk tiers based on feature adoption and support behavior. Active vs churned distributions were analyzed by risk level. Finally accounts were also grouped by signup month and tracked over time to calculate retention rates and analyze recurring revenue trends.

# SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS

The analysis is diagnostic in nature and does not model causal or counterfactual scenarios. Churn reasons were derived from churn event categories rather than all contributing factors. Risk scoring was based on available data and can be improved on with additional behavioural signals. Support ticket analysis relied on ticket signals rather than the content of support interactions. Cohort retention is calculated based on available account lifespan data with assumed consistent tracking during the analysis period. Analysis results and recommendations are intended to assist retention strategy and prioritisation rather than offer specific interventions. Recommendations should be validated through targeted A/B testing before full scale implementation.